

Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.132-138 · Eye/face, head, foot, hand, electrical, respirator rules

DATE _____ FACILITATOR _____ DEPT / SHIFT _____ HEADCOUNT _____

WHY THIS MEETING

PPE is the last line of defense after guards, ventilation, and safe work practices. Today covers what to wear for the job, how to inspect it, and when damaged gear comes out of service.

TODAY'S TALKING POINTS

1. The company assesses hazards and issues the right PPE for the task — not whatever is left in the bin.
2. Wear assigned PPE the entire time the hazard is present. Glasses stay on in the shop, not around your neck.
3. Inspect before each use. Cracked lenses, torn gloves, and clogged cartridges do not protect you.
4. Fit matters. Loose glasses or an untested respirator create a false sense of safety.
5. Report damaged or missing PPE before you start. You will not be asked to work without required protection.
6. PPE has limits. Glasses are not goggles. A dust mask is not a respirator. The wrong glove can hold a chemical against your skin.

WEAR THE RIGHT GEAR

- Eyes: safety glasses with side shields; goggles or a face shield for grinding, splash, or flying chips.
- Hands: match the glove to the hazard (cut, chemical, heat). No gloves near rotating bits, spindles, or rollers.
- Feet: closed-toe work shoes; safety-toe where required.
- Hearing: plugs or muffs in posted high-noise areas for the full exposure.
- Head: hard hat where overhead or struck-by hazards exist.
- Respirator: only the unit you were trained, medically cleared, and fit-tested to wear (1910.134).

DO

- Put PPE on before you enter the hazard area.
- Clean and store gear so the next person can use it.
- Replace disposable items on schedule — do not stretch a dirty pair.
- Ask if the task, chemical, or machine setup changed.

DON'T

- Modify PPE: no cut earplugs, no removed side shields.
- Share sweaty respirators or disposable earplugs.
- Use damaged gear "just this once." Take it out of service.
- Wear rings, hoodies, or loose sleeves that can catch in equipment.

ASK THE CREW

1. What PPE is required at your station today, and what hazard does each piece stop?
2. When did you last take something out of service? What was wrong with it?
3. Where do you get a replacement if yours fails mid-shift?

STOP WORK IF

Required PPE is missing, damaged, or does not fit — or anyone says to "just skip it for a minute." Get a supervisor.

ATTENDANCE · PRINT NAME AND INITIAL

1. _____	2. _____
3. _____	4. _____
5. _____	6. _____
7. _____	8. _____